Edurance: board summary

Inputs: `founder/idea.md`, `founder/board/brief.md`, the three memos in `founder/board/`. Date: 2026-10-20. Every number below is either something the founders said, a threshold proposed for the founders to confirm, or marked UNKNOWN. No figure here is a measured result.

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1. The vote

3 × FUND IF, 0 PASS. Average score 4.3 / 10.

Lens	Score	Vote	One line
Offers	4	FUND IF	The outcome people want is strong and schools are easy to reach, but nothing proves it works, the payer is undefined and ₹299 may leave no margin.
Monopoly	4	FUND IF	150 schools is a good small market to own first, but nothing stops a copycat built on the same OpenAI APIs, and school sales may never compound.
Product	5	FUND IF	It is well built where nobody looks, but it does too many things for too many users, and the handovers between school, teacher, student and parent are undesigned.

All three members say the same thing in different words. **This is a credible team with a working product and no evidence yet.** None of them passed, because the product is real and the market is reachable. None of them funded outright, because no one has yet adopted it, used it consistently, learned from it or paid for it.

Where they disagree (kept on purpose):

- **Scope.** The Product lens wants a hard cut to one grade band, one subject and one loop, with PlayLab frozen. The Offers lens wants *more* in the offer: a stack of a diagnostic report, a plan, parent reports and a guarantee. These fit together only if the stack is built from what already exists, not from new features.
- **Engagement bar.** Offers asks for 50% weekly active users (WAU) at week 6. Product asks for 40% active in each of weeks 4–6. Neither has a baseline. Section 5 uses one shared threshold for the founders to confirm.
- **What to prove first.** Monopoly cares most about owning one zone and getting referrals between schools. Offers cares most about who pays and margin. Product cares most about the first session and sustained use. The 30-day plan orders them: usage first, then payment, then repeatability.

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2. The extended board: perspectives Edurance needs

The founder-board skill seats three framework lenses. You asked for domain seats as well. These are the challenges each seat should bring to every board review. They are not separate memos.

Seat	What it must challenge	The question it should keep asking
Education / pedagogy	Whether the diagnostic measures what it claims. Whether adaptive paths follow the syllabus of each school's board (CBSE, ICSE, Telangana State Board) and its language of instruction. Whether "mastery" is defined in a way a teacher would accept. Whether gains are real or just practice effects from retaking the same test.	"Compared with what? How would a teacher know this child learned more because of Edurance?"
School sales / partnerships	Who actually decides (owner, correspondent, principal, academic coordinator). The buying calendar: the academic year, term starts and exam season. Whether a pilot is a commitment or a polite yes. What the school gains: revenue share, a reputation for being modern, less teacher workload, or results.	"Who signs, who blocks, and what does the school get that it can show to parents?"
AI / product technology	Whether explanations are correct and on the syllabus. Whether they suit the student's age. Latency on school Wi-Fi and low-end phones. The OpenAI cost per active student. Uptime during a class period. What happens when the API is slow or wrong in front of 40 students.	"What does one active student cost per month, and what happens when the AI is wrong?"
Finance	Net revenue per user after the school share, refunds and payment fees. Contribution after AI and hosting cost. Cash runway against the sales cycle. Whether ₹299 is per month, per term or per year (this changes everything).	"After the school's share and the AI bill, what is left per paid user, and how many months of runway is that?"
Child privacy and safety	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 and its rules require verifiable parental consent before processing a child's personal data. They also restrict tracking, behavioural monitoring and targeted advertising aimed at children. Edurance profiles learning behaviour and sends data to an overseas AI provider, so this is core, not paperwork. Also: how long data is kept, who at the school sees what, and how the AI chat or voice is moderated.	"Could we show a parent, a principal and a regulator exactly what data we hold on their child, where it goes, and who consented?" Confirm with a lawyer before pilots go live.
Business operations	Who runs orientation and onboarding, who handles support tickets during class hours, the service level per school, and how many schools four founders can serve at once before quality drops.	"If 10 schools say yes next month, who shows up at each one and what breaks first?"

3. The business model, assessed

Element	Assessment	Status
Customer	Three parties. Students use it, schools choose it, parents may pay. The real buyer is undecided, and this is the single biggest gap in the model.	Payer UNKNOWN
Problem	Real and widely felt: mixed-ability classrooms, students who fall behind and never catch up, parents spending on tuition. Not yet shown: that *these* schools rank this problem high enough to act on it now.	Assumption
Value proposition	Today it is a feature list: diagnostics, adaptive learning, AI explanations, voice, tracking, dashboards. It needs to be a named outcome with a time frame, e.g. "every student's gaps found in week 1, a measurable gain on the re-test by end of term".	Unproven

Element	Assessment	Status
Pricing	₹299 per paid user. The billing period, who pays and the school share are all UNKNOWN. Low enough to feel easy to say yes to, but possibly too low to cover AI cost, the school share and onboarding labour. Willingness to pay is untested.	Assumption
Distribution	Going through schools is the right instinct: one yes reaches a whole cohort, and 150 named prospects in four zones is a bounded target. Risk: every school costs significant founder time (demo, proposal, orientation, onboarding), so the channel may not scale without references between schools.	Planned, unproven
Repeatable revenue	Possible if (a) pilots convert at a predictable rate, (b) students keep paying term after term or year after year, and (c) schools renew and refer. None of the three has been observed.	UNKNOWN

The board's read: the model is coherent on paper, but it is really two businesses that share a product. One sells to schools (B2B). The other sells to parents through schools (B2B2C). The next 30 days should find out which one is real in Hyderabad, rather than run both.

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4. Risks, ranked

Severity is how badly it hurts if true. Uncertainty is how little we know today. The most severe and most uncertain risks come first.

#	Risk	Severity	Uncertainty	Raised by
1	**No one pays, or the wrong party is asked to pay.** The school does the work while the parent is asked for the money, or vice versa.	Critical	High	Offers, Product, Finance
2	**Students stop using it after onboarding.** It becomes a novelty in week 1 and dead by week 4.	Critical	High	Offers, Product
3	**No measurable learning gain**, or a gain that can't be told apart from practice effects. Without it there is no proof, no renewal and no referrals.	High	High	Offers, Monopoly, Education
4	**Unit economics are negative.** ₹299 minus the school share, payment fees, OpenAI cost and support leaves nothing.	High	High	Offers, Monopoly, Finance
5	**Schools say "pilot" but don't commit**: no named owner, no timetable slot, no success metric.	High	High	Offers, School sales
6	**Child-data compliance gap**: parental consent, data leaving India, profiling of minors. One incident can end school trust across the whole city.	High	Medium	Privacy (none of the lenses, so the board flags it)
7	**AI explanation errors** (wrong, off-syllabus, wrong level) read aloud to a child in class.	High	Medium	Product, AI/tech
8	**Founder bandwidth**: onboarding and support for even 5–10 schools takes over the time needed for sales.	Medium	Medium	Monopoly, Operations
9	**No durable edge**: a national player, an LMS vendor or a free AI chat tool offers "good enough" for free.	Medium	Medium	Monopoly

#	Risk	Severity	Uncertainty	Raised by
10	**Focus spread across PlayLab and early years**, which is a different user and a different product.	Medium	Low	Product

Facts vs assumptions vs unverified claims

Known facts (stated by founders)	Assumptions (planning inputs)	Unknown / unverified
A working web product (Flutter, Supabase, OpenAI, Vercel)	Schools will adopt via pilots	Signed schools or pilots to date
Built: auth, diagnostics, resume, adaptive flows, AI explanations, TTS, parent view	₹299 is an acceptable price	Who pays, the billing period, the school revenue share
A 150-school prospect list across 4 zones	October funnel targets	Active users, engagement, retention
4 co-founders across tech, business, ops and product	Students will keep using it	Learning outcomes
Initial market: Hyderabad and Secunderabad	Parents will pay after a school pilot	AI and hosting cost per student; operating costs
	Learning gains will drive conversion	Budget and runway
		Conversion rates at any stage
		Exact role ownership per founder

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5. Merged conditions (checklist for the rest of the pack)

Thresholds marked ◇ are board proposals for the founders to confirm, not benchmarks.

☐ **Payer and terms fixed in writing**: who pays (school or parent), the billing period, the school share and what the school gets. *(Offers, Product)* → `/founder-pricing`, `/founder-cfo`
☐ **One sentence, one core loop**: one grade band, one subject, diagnose → explain → practise → re-test. PlayLab and non-core features frozen until sustained use is shown. *(Product)*
☐ **Structured pilots signed**: ◇ at least 3 schools, each with a named decision-maker, a timetable slot and an agreed success metric. *(Offers)*
☐ **Own one zone**: ◇ at least 25% of one zone's schools signed in an agreed window. *(Monopoly)*
☐ **First session works without founders**: ◇ at least 80% of a class completes onboarding and the diagnostic in one period, in at least 2 schools. *(Product)*
☐ **Sustained use**: ◇ at least 40% of onboarded students active weekly in weeks 4–6 (Offers proposed 50% at week 6, Product 40%; start at 40% and raise it once you have a baseline). *(Offers, Product)*
☐ **Learning gain measured**: baseline to follow-up diagnostic, ideally against a comparison group that didn't use it, reported per school. *(Offers, Monopoly)*
☐ **Explanation quality**: ◇ at least 100 AI explanations reviewed by teachers, error rate below 2%, and a defined process for correcting them. *(Product)*
☐ **Someone pays**: at least one pilot converts to paid, with the real conversion rate recorded. *(Offers)* → `/founder-consumer`, `/founder-pricing`
☐ **Unit economics with real inputs**: net revenue per user after the school share > AI + hosting + support per user. *(Offers, Monopoly)* → `/founder-cfo`

☐ **A named offer with a guarantee**, tested against the plain feature pitch in ◇ at least 10 school meetings. *(Offers)* → `/founder-offer`
☐ **A referral between schools**: at least one school signed through an existing pilot school. *(Monopoly)*
☐ **A written answer to "what stops a copycat"** that rests on something Edurance owns, not on the AI model. *(Monopoly)*
☐ **Child-data compliance**: a parental consent flow, a data map (what goes to OpenAI and where), a retention policy and legal review, before any pilot goes live. *(Board, privacy seat)*

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6. Founder execution: who owns what

Role allocation is **UNCONFIRMED**. This is the structure the board recommends. The gaps are where accountability is likely to slip.

Owner	Must own (single point of accountability)	Metric they answer for
Business and partnerships	The school pipeline: outreach, meetings, proposals, signed pilots, the commercial terms (payer, share, pricing)	Meetings held → pilots signed, and time from first meeting to signing
Operations	Pilot delivery: orientation, onboarding, support during class hours, the school relationship after signing, compliance paperwork (consent forms)	First-session completion rate, support response time, school satisfaction
Product	The core loop, the parent and teacher experience, explanation quality review, defining the success metric and learning-gain measurement	Weekly active rate, learning gain, explanation error rate
Technology	Reliability during class periods, AI and hosting cost per student, data security and the technical side of compliance	Uptime in class hours, ₹ cost per active student per month, incident count

Where accountability is likely to blur:

1. **The four zones.** If each founder also "owns" a zone, every founder is doing sales, and nobody is building product or running delivery full-time. Decide whether zones are a sales territory (one owner) or a shared duty with a clear time cap.
2. **Paid conversion.** Is it sales (terms), product (value shown to parents) or ops (the parent journey)? Give it one owner. The board suggests Business, with Product as support.
3. **Learning outcomes.** Is it product or education? Someone has to own measurement design, or no one will.
4. **Child privacy.** It sits between tech, ops and legal. Name one founder.
5. **Pricing and unit economics.** If no one owns the spreadsheet, ₹299 never gets tested against cost.

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7. Validation experiments (low-cost, measurable)

None of these needs new spending beyond what exists, apart from possible printing or travel. The budget is UNKNOWN, so tell the board before any experiment that would cost money.

#	Experiment	Tests risk	How	Success (◇ confirm)	Kill or pivot signal
E1	**Free gap-report offer to schools**	5, 1	Offer each school a free baseline diagnostic for one class plus a gap report for the principal. Ask for a structured pilot only after the report is delivered.	◇ at least 30% of meetings agree to a diagnostic; at least 50% of those agree to a structured pilot	Fewer than 1 in 10 meetings say yes even to free: the problem isn't urgent for schools
E2	**Payer test**	1	In the same meetings, present two written term sheets: (A) the school pays per student; (B) the parent pays ₹299 and the school gets a share. Record which they choose and why.	A clear majority preference, with stated reasons	Schools refuse both: rethink the model before building billing
E3	**Observed first period**	2, 7	In 1–2 schools, a founder watches a full class onboard and take the diagnostic without helping, and logs every point where a student gets stuck.	◇ at least 80% complete in one period	Below 60%: fix onboarding before signing more schools
E4	**4-week usage cohort**	2	Track weekly active rate by student, class and school from Supabase. Compare classes with a teacher nudge against classes without one.	◇ at least 40% weekly active in week 4	Below 20% by week 3 even with a teacher nudge: the core loop isn't sticky
E5	**Pre-sale to parents**	1, 4	After the gap report, send parents the child's report and a ₹299 offer (state the period), with a real payment link or a signed commitment form.	Any measurable paid conversion; record the rate	No payments from a cohort with real reports: the parent isn't the payer at this price
E6	**Explanation audit**	7	Two teachers review 100 logged AI explanations for correctness, syllabus fit and age level.	◇ error rate below 2%	Above 5%: pause voice and AI explanations in pilots until fixed
E7	**Cost per active student**	4	Read OpenAI, Supabase and Vercel billing for the cohort and divide by active students.	Cost is a small fraction of net revenue per user	Cost is at or above net revenue per user: change the architecture or the price
E8	**Re-test gain**	3	Re-run the diagnostic (parallel items, not identical) after 4–6 weeks, ideally against a class that didn't use it.	A positive gain larger than in the comparison class	No difference: the product isn't teaching yet

8. 30-day validation plan

Rule for the month: no new features, no paid tools and no hires. Use only what exists. PlayLab is frozen.

Week 1: decide and prepare

- Confirm founder roles and owners (section 6). Name one owner for paid conversion and one for child privacy.

- Pick the one grade band, one subject and one zone.
- Write down the payer options (E2) and answer what ₹299 covers and for what period.
- Put a parental consent flow and a one-page data map in place. Get a legal opinion on the DPDP Act requirements.
- Set up the metric sheet: meetings, pilots, completion, weekly active, re-test, cost per student.
- Start E6 (explanation audit) and E7 (cost) right away. They need no school.

Week 2: sell the free diagnostic

- Book decision-maker meetings in the chosen zone. Run E1 + E2 in every meeting, and test the named offer against the plain pitch (condition: ◇ at least 10 meetings).
- Log for each meeting: who attended, the decision-maker's role, the objection, the yes or no, and their payer preference.

Week 3: deliver

- Run E3 (observed first period) at every school that agreed. Fix onboarding blockers within days.
- Start E4 (usage tracking). Deliver gap reports to principals and parents.
- Send the E5 parent offer once reports are in parents' hands.

Week 4: measure and decide

- Report the week-4 weekly active rate, parent conversion, cost per student, explanation error rate and meeting-to-pilot rate.
- Board review against the decision gates below. Schedule the E8 re-test for weeks 6–8.

Decisions that depend on the results

If…	Then…
Schools take the free diagnostic but won't commit to a structured pilot	Problem is acknowledged but not urgent. Rework the offer (`/founder-offer`) before more outreach.
Schools prefer to pay themselves (E2 = A)	Run as B2B: price per school or per student per year, and drop parent billing for now.
Schools prefer parent-pays and parents convert (E5 > 0)	Run as B2B2C: confirm the share, then model it with `/founder-cfo`.
Weekly active rate is below 20% by week 3–4	Stop selling and fix the core loop. More schools would just mean more churn.
Cost per student ≥ net revenue per user	Change the model (cache, a cheaper model, fewer calls) or the price before scaling.
Explanation error rate is above 5%	Pull AI explanations and voice from live pilots until it's fixed.
All gates green in one zone	Expand to the next zone, ask pilot schools for referrals and run `/founder-cfo` with real inputs.

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9. Questions the board needs answered (these change the evaluation)

1. **Budget and runway:** how much cash is available, and for how many months? (This changes whether a 90-day pilot cycle is affordable.)

2. **₹299 per what?** Monthly, per term or per year? And today, is the payer the school, the parent, or still open?
3. **Current commitments:** how many of the 150 schools have you actually met, demoed to, or got a yes or a pilot from so far? Even "zero" is a useful answer.
4. **Usage to date:** how many real students have used the product, and is there any engagement or retention data?
5. **Grades, subjects and boards:** which grade band, subject and school boards (CBSE, ICSE, State) does the content cover today?
6. **Cost per student:** is there any OpenAI or TTS bill you can divide by active users?
7. **Founder roles:** who is doing what today, and are founders full-time?
8. **Compliance:** is there a parental consent step, and what student data goes to OpenAI?

The strongest version the board can see

This differs from the pitch. The strongest Edurance in the near term is not "an AI tutor for every school student". It is a **diagnostic-led learning-gap service for one grade band and one subject, sold to schools in one zone of Hyderabad**. It starts with a free gap report for each class, which gives the principal something to show parents. It turns into a term-long, measured catch-up programme with a before-and-after re-test the school can put in front of families. The AI explanations and voice are how it is delivered, not what is being sold. What is sold is *a measured result per class, with almost no teacher effort*. If schools pay for that, or reliably bring parents who do, the diagnostic and mastery data built up across a zone's schools becomes the edge the Monopoly lens is looking for. The broader adaptive tutor, PlayLab and expansion beyond Hyderabad all wait until that loop is shown to work.

Next step: `/founder-competitors` to map who already sells into these 150 schools, then `/founder-consumer` to put the gap-report offer and the ₹299 payer question in front of simulated principals and parents before the real meetings in week 2.

Parent panel results (20 simulated parents)

6 buy · 14 pass (30% buy) out of 20 simulated buyers. Seed 149644, so the same cards can be dealt again.

These are simulated buyers, not customers. Use this to find objections and weak spots, then confirm the big ones with real people before you spend.

By segment

group	buyers	buy rate
Parent at a premium or international-curriculum school	4	50% (thin)
Parent at a mid-fee private school (fees roughly ₹60k-1.5L a year)	8	38%
Parent at a budget private school (fees roughly ₹25k-60k a year)	8	12%

By buying behaviour

group	buyers	buy rate
Marks-focused	4	75% (thin)
Follows the school	3	67% (thin)
Tech-curious	2	50% (thin)
Burned by an edtech app	2	0% (thin)
Screen-time worrier	2	0% (thin)
Tuition-first	5	0% (thin)
Price-careful	2	0% (thin)

By income

group	buyers	buy rate
₹1,271,000 and up	7	43% (thin)
₹662,000 to ₹1,271,000	7	29% (thin)
under ₹662,000	6	17% (thin)

Why they pass

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	5	"I'll look at the free report and let him finish the pilot, but I'm not paying an AI company every month for my son's test data. I paid for a big learning app before and he dropped it in three weeks, and I work late so nobody is going to sit with him to make sure he uses it." (P001) · "I'll let my son use it during the free pilot since the school chose it, but I'm not paying to keep feeding his test results and learning data to an AI company I know nothing about. I already use ChatGPT and YouTube with him for free, so ₹299 isn't buying me something I can't roughly do myself." (P005)

reason	buyers	in their words
habit	5	"We already pay a tuition teacher who sits with my child and knows exactly where she struggles, and more screen time is the last thing she needs. I'll look at the free report and pass it to her tutor, but I won't pay another ₹299 a month for an app." (P008) · "I already paid for a big learning app and my son stopped opening it within weeks, so I will not pay ₹299 a month again until I see him actually using this one on his own. The free report is useful, but YouTube and free apps can cover those gap topics." (P013)
need	2	"I already work hard to keep my son off the phone, and this asks me to pay ₹299 a month to put him back on it. The free report is useful and I will take it to the PTM, but I would rather the teacher work on those gaps in class." (P002) · "My child already goes to tuition and I am paying for that every month; ₹299 more for an app on my phone that we only share in the evenings feels like one more thing we won't keep up with. If the school asked us to pay for it with the fees I might, but this is a separate payment to some company." (P014)
values	1	"I already fight to keep my son off the phone and tablet, and this is one more app asking for screen time on top of school and tuition. The free report is useful, but I am not paying ₹299 a month to give him another reason to be on a device." (P006)
price	1	"I already pay fees for more than one child, and ₹299 a month for each of them turns into a new bill every month for something the school should be teaching anyway. The free report is useful, so I'll use the pilot, but I won't pay to keep it going." (P011)

Why they buy

reason	buyers	in their words
need	4	"The school itself picked this and the report shows exactly which topics my child is weak in, so if the teacher says at the PTM that it helps marks, ₹299 is less than one tuition class. I'll pay for a month and watch the parent view closely." (P012) · "The school itself is running it and the report already shows exactly which topics my son is weak in, so for ₹299 a month next to what I pay for tuition, I will keep it going for the exam term. If the school is backing it, the other parents will continue too and I don't want him to fall behind." (P015)
trust	1	"The school brought this in and the report already showed me where my child is behind, so if the teachers say continue, I will pay. ₹299 is less than one tuition session and I don't have time to sit with homework myself." (P003)
habit	1	"If the school is running it in my child's class and the report already shows where she is behind, I'll just continue it. ₹299 a month is nothing next to the fees, and my relative's child is doing the same thing." (P004)

What would flip a no

- If the school itself told me in writing that the data stays with the school and isn't sold or used for anything else, and his class teacher showed me his marks actually went up during the free pilot.
- If his class teacher told me at the PTM that the app follows exactly what they teach and that his test scores went up during the pilot, with a fixed daily time limit I can set myself.
- A clear written data policy, signed off by the school, saying my child's data is not sold or used for training and is deleted if I cancel, plus the weekly parent view actually showing his weak topics improving during the pilot.
- If the school's own teachers assigned it as part of homework mapped chapter by chapter to his syllabus, with a fixed daily limit like 20 minutes, and the parent view showed his test marks actually improving after the pilot.

- The school recommending it officially, or other parents in the class showing me their children's marks went up after using it this term.
- If the school's own teachers used it in class and the term-end report showed my child's weak topics clearly improved, enough that I could cut back on tuition.
- If the school itself told me in writing that the data stays with the school and is not sold or used by the company, and the class teacher showed me his marks actually went up during the pilot.
- The school's own teachers vouching for it at the end of the pilot, with proof my child's weak topics actually improved, and a sibling price so two kids don't cost ₹600 a month.
- If the school included it in the fees, or there was one low family price for all my children, and the teacher or my relative's family showed me real marks going up after the pilot.
- If the teacher shows me at the parent-teacher meeting that his weak topics actually improved during the free pilot, and the school keeps using it in class so he keeps practising.
- If the class teacher said every child should continue with it and it was being used for homework, so it replaces some tuition and isn't extra.
- If the school covered it in the fees, or if the teacher or our tuition sir actually used the report and assigned work from it so it replaced something we already pay for.

Buyers say they would buy **1.0 times** in the first month on average.

20 buyers gave all four price answers. Run founder-pricing's van_westendorp.py on the answers folder.

Appendix: board memos

Offers lens

Score: 4/10 | Vote: FUND IF

What is strong

- **The dream outcome is the right one.** "Close your child's learning gaps" is a large, emotional outcome that parents and schools already care about. The diagnostic gives a natural before-and-after to prove it.
- **The buyers are easy to find.** 150 named schools across four zones, each with a founder who owns it, is a reachable, bounded market. Selling to schools reaches groups of students at once, which beats selling one student at a time.
- **A working product exists.** Diagnostics, adaptive flows, TTS and parent views are built, so the cost of testing an offer is low.
- **The diagnostic is a ready-made entry offer.** A free or cheap baseline report showing each student's gaps is cheap to deliver and valuable to both schools and parents.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **No proof, so low perceived likelihood.** Engagement, retention and learning-outcome evidence are all UNKNOWN. Without results, a school has no reason to believe the outcome will happen, and price becomes the only thing anyone talks about.
2. **Unclear buyer, and a lot of effort asked.** Nobody has said who pays the ₹299, or for what period. The school is asked to give meetings, sign proposals, run educator orientation and onboard students. If the school does all that work and the parent pays, the offer asks a lot of one party and gives the money to another.
3. **A commodity offer at a low price.** "AI explanations plus narration" is a list of features, not a named result. At ₹299, with the revenue share and AI API cost per student UNKNOWN, there may be no margin left to fund the onboarding and support that schools will expect.

The questions I would ask the founder

- Who pays the ₹299, for what period, and what does the school receive in return?
- What specific result can you promise in how many weeks, for example "measurable gain on the follow-up diagnostic within one term"?
- Would you offer a guarantee, such as a refund or a free extra term if the follow-up diagnostic shows no gain? Can you afford it?
- What is the AI API cost per active student per month?
- What does a school have to do, in hours of staff time, to get students active?
- What would make a principal feel stupid saying no: a free baseline gap report for every class? A teacher dashboard? Parent reports?
- Could you charge double and still be the obvious choice? If not, why not?

If FUND IF: the conditions

1. **Payer and terms defined in writing.** The payer (school or parent), billing period and school revenue share are fixed before the next pilot is signed.

2. **Pilots signed.** At least 3 of the 150 schools sign structured pilots within 90 days, each with a named decision-maker and an agreed success metric.
3. **Usage holds.** At least 50% of onboarded pilot students are active weekly in week 6.
4. **Outcome proof.** Pilot students show a measurable gain from baseline to follow-up diagnostic over one term, reported per school.
5. **Someone pays.** At least one pilot converts to paid at ₹299, with the actual conversion rate recorded.
6. **Unit economics known.** AI API cost plus support cost per paid user is measured and below net revenue per user after the revenue share.
7. **The offer has a name and a guarantee.** A named, outcome-based offer (diagnostic, plan, progress reports, guarantee) is tested against the plain feature pitch in at least 10 school meetings.

Monopoly lens

Score: 4 | Vote: FUND IF

What is strong

- **A small market that can be named and counted.** 150 schools in Hyderabad and Secunderabad, split into four zones with one founder each. The Monopoly lens favours exactly this: start with a large share of a small market. Owning one zone is a goal you can measure.
- **The route to customers is the school, not ads to parents.** One school decision can bring in a whole cohort of students. That is a real answer to the lens's question of how the first 100 customers arrive, if pilots convert.
- **A product that works and is already built.** It has diagnostics, adaptive flows, TTS narration and parent visibility, so the team is testing distribution, not still building.
- **Possible data moat.** Diagnostic and mastery data per student, per school, mapped to local syllabi, could build up into know-how a newcomer would not have. Today it is only possible. Nothing yet shows the data exists or that it improves the product.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **No proprietary edge.** Adaptive practice and AI explanations built on OpenAI APIs can be copied in months. Large national K-12 edtech platforms, school ERP/LMS vendors adding AI features, and free general-purpose AI chat tools all reach the same school and parent. Nothing yet stops a copycat in month six, and nothing is shown to be 10x better on something that matters.
2. **Distribution that never compounds.** School sales are slow and done face to face, with demos, proposals, pilots, orientation and onboarding. If every school costs weeks of founder time and Hyderabad does not produce references that pull in the next school, there are no economies of scale. The business becomes a services operation.
3. **Margin squeezed from both sides.** At ₹299 per paid user, the school revenue share and the per-student OpenAI cost both come out of the same small amount. Neither number is known. The lens says competition destroys profit, and a commodity AI layer sold through intermediaries is where that happens.

The questions I would ask the founder

- What is the secret? What do you know about Hyderabad schools, or how these students learn, that the national players do not?
- Which one thing is 10x better than what a school uses today? How would you measure it?

- Which zone will you own first, and what share of its schools counts as "owning" it?
- Who else is already selling to these 150 schools, and why did those schools buy them?
- What does it cost to acquire one school, counted in founder hours and cash, and how long from first meeting to signed pilot?
- What is the AI API cost per active student per month? What is the school revenue share?
- Does student data make the product better for the next student, in a way a competitor cannot match without the same data?
- Why now? What has changed that makes this possible today and not three years ago?

If FUND IF: the conditions

1. **Own one zone first.** Signed paid or structured pilots with a set share of one zone's schools (the founders propose the target; we suggest at least 25% of that zone) within an agreed window.
2. **Proof it is clearly better.** A measured learning gain between baseline and follow-up diagnostics in pilot cohorts, compared with a non-using group, plus weekly active use above an agreed threshold after 8 weeks.
3. **Unit economics on paper with real inputs.** Net revenue per paid user after the school share, minus AI and hosting cost per user, is positive and documented from pilot data.
4. **Distribution that repeats.** At least one new school signed through a referral from an existing pilot school, not through cold outreach.
5. **A written answer to "what stops a copycat in month six"** that rests on something the team owns (data, syllabus mapping, school relationships), not on the OpenAI model.

Product lens

Score: 5 | Vote: FUND IF

What is strong

- It exists and runs. Diagnostics with persistence, lesson resumption, adaptive flows, AI explanations, TTS narration with replay and caching, and a parent view are built. The unglamorous parts (resume where you left off, audio caching) are signs of craft where nobody looks.
- The diagnostic is a natural "first five minutes": a student finishes a short test and sees exactly what they do not know yet. That is a moment worth designing everything back from.
- School-led rollout puts a whole class in front of the product at once, with a teacher present, which is the best setting to watch the experience and fix it.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **No one thing.** Diagnostics, adaptive paths, AI explanations, voice, mastery tracking, parent visibility, school visibility, plus PlayLab for early years. The pitch needs a paragraph. With four founders and no stated budget, every feature is shallow and none is brilliant. PlayLab is a different user (pre-readers) and a different product; it should not ship now.
2. **Seams between school, teacher, student and parent.** The school signs, the teacher orients, the student uses it, the parent may pay ₹299. Each handover is a place it breaks: a teacher who never opens the school view, a student who stops after onboarding, a parent asked to pay for something the school chose. Who pays is UNKNOWN, so the payment touchpoint itself is undesigned.
3. **AI explanation quality the founders cannot see.** An OpenAI-generated explanation that is wrong, off-syllabus for the board the school follows, or pitched at the wrong level, read

aloud by TTS to a child, damages trust with the teacher and parent at once. There is no stated review or quality check. Learning-outcome evidence is UNKNOWN.

The questions I would ask the founder

- Say Edurance in one sentence. Which single feature would you keep if you had to cut the rest?
- Walk me through a Class 7 student's first five minutes after the teacher says "log in". What do they see, and when do they hear the voice?
- What does the teacher do with it on Monday morning, and how long does that take?
- Who pays ₹299, for what period, and what does the parent see before being asked?
- How do you check that AI explanations are correct and match the school's syllabus and language of instruction?
- What is AI API cost per active student per month? (UNKNOWN today.)
- Why is PlayLab being built before one school has shown sustained use?

If FUND IF: the conditions

1. **One sentence, one core loop.** Founders commit in writing to one grade band, one subject and one loop (diagnose, explain, practise, re-test); PlayLab and non-core features frozen until condition 3 is met.
2. **Observed first session.** In at least 2 pilot schools, a full class completes onboarding and the diagnostic in one period without founder help, with at least 80% of students finishing.
3. **Sustained use.** At least 40% of onboarded students active in each of weeks 4 to 6 of the pilot (threshold to be confirmed by the board, since no engagement baseline exists).
4. **Explanation quality.** A sample of at least 100 AI explanations reviewed by teachers, with an error rate below 2% and a defined correction process.
5. **Payer defined.** Who pays, billing period and school share stated, and the payment step tested with real parents or schools before any scale-up.